

V Feedback & Revision Workshop

A structured review session: your community reads the Ten Commandments closely and tells us exactly how to make them better.

AUDIENCE

Educators, clergy, camp leadership, education committees, and staff teams. This is a working session for adults reviewing the document in depth.

GROUP SIZE

Three to twenty participants, working in small groups of three or four.

ROOM

Tables to write at. No other setup needed.

STAFFING

One facilitator who also records the final recommendations.

Materials

- ☐ The full Ten Commandments document, one per person
- ☐ Educator Review Worksheets, one per person
- ☐ Pens, and a whiteboard or large paper for the full-group list

Timing

This program can be adapted based on time available.

Segment	45 min	60 min	90 min
1. Welcome and framing	5	5	10
2. Individual review	15	20	25
3. Small group synthesis	10	15	20
4. Full group report and consensus	10	15	25
5. Commitments and next steps	5	5	10
Total	45	60	90

Pick your column and follow it top to bottom; each column adds up on its own.

Running the Session

1. Welcome and Framing (5/5/10 min)

Name the goal plainly: this document is a living draft, and this session exists to strengthen it. The goal is not critique for its own sake but making the commandments serve your community as effectively as possible. Every recommendation produced today goes back to the project.

SUGGESTED FRAMING

Jewish tradition honors *machloket l'shem shamayim*, disagreement for the sake of heaven (*Pirkei Avot 5:17*). A text becomes Torah by being argued with. Today we give this document the honor of a real argument.

2. Individual Review (15/20/25 min)

Working alone with the document and the Educator Review Worksheet, each person notes, for as many commandments as time allows:

Three Categories

- **Strengths:** What works well? What language, values, or framings are particularly effective?
- **Concerns:** Is anything unclear, potentially alienating, missing important nuance, or not age-appropriate?
- **Suggested revisions:** Specific wording changes, additional Jewish sources, updated research, or structural suggestions.

FIELD NOTE

Skipping rows is fine; a few thoughtful entries beat a full grid. Encourage reviewers to spend their time where they have real expertise: a youth worker on realism, a rabbi on the sources, a parent on the tone.

3. Small Group Synthesis (10/15/20 min)

In groups of three or four, share individual feedback and find the areas of consensus. Each group prepares its top three to five recommendations, sorted into:

Recommendation Types

- Highest-priority revisions (changes the group feels are essential)
- Suggested additions (new content, sources, or commandments to consider)
- Contextual adaptations (changes specific to your community, age group, or setting)

4. Full Group Report and Consensus (10/15/25 min)

Each small group shares its top recommendations while the facilitator records everything where the room can see it. Then lead a consensus conversation:

Consensus Questions

- Which recommendations have the broadest support?
- Do any suggestions conflict with each other? How do we resolve them?
- Is the content well calibrated for the age groups we serve?
- What would we add that nobody has said yet?

5. Commitments and Next Steps (5/5/10 min)

Close with logistics, out loud and specifically: who is submitting the group's recommendations, and by when. Collect the completed worksheets. Submit everything, worksheets and the consensus list, at techrabbi.org/digital-mensches: photograph the pages, upload them, or type the summary directly.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A review process without follow-through undermines trust. Tell the group when they can expect to see the next version, and make sure their feedback actually gets sent.

Facilitation Notes

- **Feedback is the product.** In other Digital Mensches programs the conversation is the point; here the recorded recommendations are. Guard the recording role.
- **Balance the voices.** Small groups let quieter reviewers land their points before the full-group personalities take over. Keep the small-group step even when short on time.
- **Disagreement is data.** When the room splits on a recommendation, record both positions and the reasoning. A genuine split is as useful to the revision as a consensus.
- **Run the program first if you can.** Reviewers who have seen a session with real teens give sharper feedback than reviewers working from the page alone.